

tomorrow's technology

Remote Storage

IBM has launched iBoot, a storage technology that lets PCs and servers use networking to assign a remotely located hard disk as its main storehouse of data. This, the company claims can prove to be economical as using centralised storage instead of internal drives can help companies cut PC maintenance costs, saving on procedures like software upgrades for PCs. iBoot uses the relatively new iSCSI networking standard, which takes advantage of standard Internet Protocol

to create a link between the PC and the remote disk drive. Although it might seem similar to mainframe computing, there are certain essential differences. In the case of an iBoot each PC continues to use its own processor and other hardware, avoiding competition with other machines for shared processing power on a mainframe.

iBoot machines are simply assigned storage space on a specific remote disk, allowing people to maintain their own data. The PC's user continues

to access or store files as if nothing has changed. This technology can be added to existing PCs and the main components are an iSCSI adaptor and a software update.

IBM sees a strong potential for iBoot as manufacturers could soon produce computers with smaller hard drives wherein you need to only temporarily store files and then connect to a networked storage drive. We might witness a reversal in the trend of high-end PCs shipping with 80-120 GB drives.

Buy one, get one free

In an endeavour to combat slipping sales, Palm has decided to give away an m105 free to those who purchase the higher end m500, priced at \$299 (approx Rs 15,000). Besides spurring sales, Palm hopes this move will increase the spread and usage of their devices by attracting new buyers who might then move on to some of the higher priced models later on.



snapshot

Shipments of Bluetooth devices to grow from less than 15 million in 2002 to 955 million units in 2005

Source: Cahners inStat Group

Computex Taipei 2002

Trade shows spell excitement, great new products and hot technologies and this year, Comdex Taipei held between June 3 and to June 7 has not disappointed. AMD announced dates on which it is going to release its much-



**COMPUTEX
TAIPEI 2002**

anticipated K8 processor. nVidia was also present en force with its CK8 chipset (codenamed Crush) which is primarily an NV17-based nForce solution for the Opteron. FIC showcased some interesting technology with its ATi A4-based motherboard which is their answer to the nForce.

ASUS launched a PDA featuring a serious amount of handheld horsepower based on a 400 MHz Intel Xscale processor (PXA259), 64 MB SDRAM, 32 MB FlashROM running Microsoft PocketPC 2002.

Besides the overwhelming presence of the motherboard and processor companies, there were a range of other products incorporating some really cool technologies. This included devices like tablet PCs that could double up as a notebook or desktops where the screen could be attached to a base-station for conventional keyboard/mouse support, to

wireless cameras based upon the 802.11b standard and a range of mice that incorporated CompactFlash and Smart Media readers and biometric functionality.

We know all too well that the last year has been a bit of a letdown economically, but if Computex Taipei 2002 is anything to go by, there is a lot in store on the technology and PC front: 64-bit processors, faster and cheaper graphics cards, motherboards that give you wireless freedom—the next few months should be very interesting indeed.

quoteworthy

"We are in two businesses which are in the process of converging. Having been through the computer wars, you know what is going to happen, you know what the end point is going to be."

Intel Chief Executive Craig Barrett on his company's plans to make further inroads into the telecommunications chip market, as equipment makers adopt cheaper and standardised components

"We can build more than we thought, we are in the business of selling computers to people who want to buy them and we've got a lot of customers who say they want to buy this product. Why shouldn't we sell it to them? So we decided to change our plan."

Apple CEO Steve Jobs on the shift in its marketing strategy of selling the eMac exclusively to the educational segment to now selling it to anyone

"If you think about it, in the private sector the US government is probably the only consumer on earth that has the power to control Microsoft's market decisions."

James Love of the Consumer Project on Technology (CPT) suggesting the government to outright buy Microsoft's software code and release it in the public domain

■ Hitachi pays \$2.05 billion for IBM's hard drive operations ■ Microsoft considers Xbox-PC connection kit ■ Macromedia ships MX tools